Introduction

"My goal is simple. It is a complete understanding of the universe, why it is as it is and why it exists at all."

—Stephen Hawking

Starry night sky is a wonder which has fascinated humans from time immemorial. Our ancestors have observed and documented the objects seen in the night sky. The field of study of the universe is called astronomy. We know that there are billions and billions of stars in the universe, although only about 6000 or so are visible to naked eye. Have you ever think of the size of our universe? The universe is unimaginably and infinitely big. Universe is commonly defined as the totality of everything that exists or is known to exist. Even though the spatial size of the entire universe is still unknown, it is possible to measure the observable universe.

The universe consists of galaxies, planets, stars, meteorites, satellites and all other forms of matter and energy. And It is a world of wonder. Let us move into this world of wonder to know more interesting facts about the place of residence of our solar system.

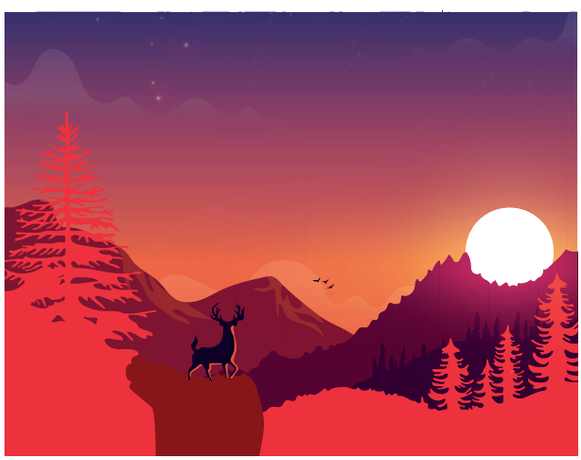
GEO Centric Theory

Sky is a wonder. Sun, Moon, stars all appear to rise in the East and move towards the West, giving us an impression that all these objects are going around the Earth. Just as in a moving bus the distant mountains and trees appear to move backwards. Perhaps really Earth is spinning and that is why Sun, Moon and stars appear to go around the Earth. Does the Earth revolve around the Sun, or the Sun revolves around the Earth? How do you know about it?

When you look at the night sky you can see lot of twinkling objects. But a few of them differ from the others. They don't twinkle and while the other stars hold a fixed pattern from night to night, these drift. They wander across the sky, moving against the backdrop of stars. These are called planets. Our ancestors observed this and they imagined a universe with the Earth at the center, the stars in the distant background, and Sun, Moon and the planets orbiting around us.

Two observations supported the idea that Earth was the center of the Universe. First, from anywhere on the Earth, the Sun appears to revolve around the Earth once in a day. While the Moon and the planets have their own motions, they also appear to revolve around the Earth about once per day. Even the celestial sphere studded with stars appears to rise and set in the evening, and make one complete rotation in a year. Second, the Earth seems to be unmoving from the perspective of an Earthbound observer; it feels stationary.





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